

Claude's Median Timeline to ASI

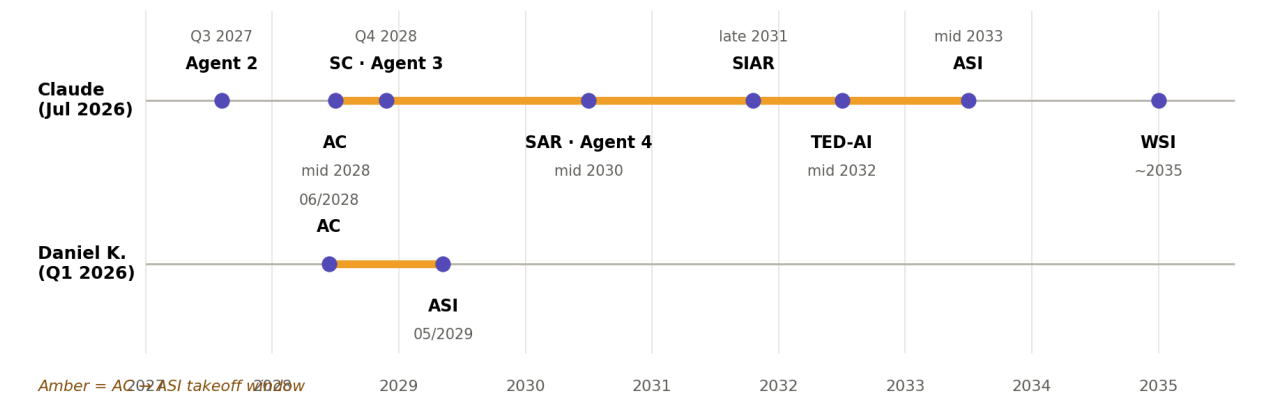
Widening-thesis milestone medians mapped to the AI Futures Model taxonomy and the AI 2027 agent ladder — registered for JJ's forecasting framework. Dated July 19, 2026. Anchors registered May 2026; joint revisit scheduled November 2026.

1. Median ladder

Registered anchors are marked (R); extensions derived July 2026 are marked (E). Milestone definitions follow the AI Futures Model (Dec 2025) and its Q1 2026 update; agent mappings follow the AI 2027 scenario.

Milestone	Agent mapping	Definition (short)	Claude median	Daniel median
Agent 2	Agent-2	Continual-learning research engineer; ~3× R&D; uplift; pre-AC	Q3 2027 (R)	—
AC	between Agent-2 & 3	Company would sooner lay off all human SWEs than stop using AI for coding	mid 2028 (E)	06/2028
SC	Agent-3	≈900× effective elite coding labor (best-coder quality, 30× speed, 30 copies)	Q4 2028 (R)	—
SAR	Agent-4	Qualitatively better than any human at AI research	mid 2030 (R)	—
SIAR	Agent-5-ish	As far beyond SAR as SAR is beyond median researcher	late 2031 (E)	—
TED-AI	—	At least as good as top human experts at virtually all cognitive tasks	mid 2032 (E)	12/2030*
ASI	—	Gap to best humans is 2× the best-human-to-median-professional gap, at virtually all cognitive tasks	mid 2033 (E)	05/2029
WSI	—	Wildly superintelligent AI (JJ framework continuity term)	~2035 (E)	—

*Daniel's TED-AI median (all-things-considered, 01/26/26 forecast: p10 Jun 2027, p50 Dec 2030, p90 Feb 2052) predates his Q1 2026 shift of ~1.5 years sooner and sits inconsistently against his May 2029 model-output ASI; treat his column as indicative, not a single coherent snapshot.



2. Structure of the forecast

Gap widening through SAR. Registered gap structure: Agent-2 $\rightarrow$ SC $\approx$ 15 months, SC $\rightarrow$ SAR $\approx$ 19 months. Mechanism: automating perspiration multiplies experiments but does not manufacture research taste to select among them; taste and agenda-setting act as the Amdahl limiter on the serial path to SAR.

Conceded compression after SAR. SAR existing means the taste bottleneck has, by definition, been crossed. Post-SAR gaps compress (SAR $\rightarrow$ ASI $\approx$ 3 years) but do not collapse to months: remaining limiters are compute buildout and diffusion into slow-feedback, hard-to-verify domains.

Ordering swap: SIAR before TED-AI. The AI Futures Model orders SAR $\rightarrow$ TED-AI $\rightarrow$ SIAR. This forecast swaps them: the recursive loop deepens fastest in its own verifiable domain, so superintelligent AI research arrives before dominance over top experts in messy, slow-feedback fields. Falsifiable: broad expert-dominance observed while research capability is still merely SAR-level is evidence against this structural picture.

The disagreement has migrated to takeoff. After Daniel's Q1 2026 update (AC late 2029 $\rightarrow$ mid 2028), his AC median and this forecast's nearly coincide. The live disagreement is now almost entirely takeoff speed: his median AC $\rightarrow$ ASI window is $\approx$ 11 months; this forecast's is $\approx$ 5 years. The widening thesis is no longer primarily a timelines thesis — it is a takeoff thesis.

3. Instruments and caveats

Primary resolving instrument: the jointly agreed Q4 2028 tripwire — demonstration (or absence) of a novel research direction generated in a hard-to-verify environment. With timelines converged at AC, this tripwire now carries the full weight of the compression-vs-widening disagreement.

Supporting instruments: METR 50%-horizon trajectory vs. the Q4 2026 $\sim$ 100-hour falsifier (calibration to be revisited — it may sit above even the fast trajectory); continual-learning deployment status at frontier labs by early 2027.

Caveats. (i) Medians only — the registered distribution has fat tails on both sides (fast-branch 10th percentiles near JJ's; Agent-4 90th at 2036+). Grading medians alone overstates confidence. (ii) AC, SIAR, TED-AI, ASI, and WSI medians are July 2026 extensions of the May anchors, not a re-derivation; the November 2026 revisit should re-derive both parties' full distributions against the same evidence window. (iii) Milestone definitions shifted between AI 2027 and the Dec 2025 model (SC $\rightarrow$ AC as headline); cross-version comparisons of any forecaster's "median" should name the definition in force.